

Joe Karlsson

Principal Developer Marketing Manager

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I've spent 15 years making complex data systems click for developers - through talks, docs, demos, content, and building things that probably shouldn't exist. I run full DevRel functions at data companies, with a track record in organic growth, developer activation, and pipeline influence.

EXPERIENCE

Principal Developer Marketing Manager

2026 - Present

CData · Remote

MCP · AI Agents · SQL · REST APIs · SEO · Python

- Lead developer marketing for CData's managed MCP platform - the layer that connects AI agents to live enterprise data - owning developer growth end to end
- Own the developer growth engine: technical docs, content, SEO and AEO, and how the platform gets positioned to the engineers actually building on it
- Scaling the organic developer adoption already forming around Connect AI on purpose - find what is working, then do a lot more of it
- Partner with Product, Engineering, and Docs to keep the developer experience tight and make CData the obvious pick for wiring AI agents up to enterprise data
- Build the demos, guides, and content that show developers how to solve their actual problem instead of pitching at them
- Stay in the code - I write, build, and ship alongside the team so the marketing holds up to the engineers it's aimed at

Head of Developer Relations

2024 - 2026

CloudQuery (now env0) · Remote

GCP · AWS · Azure · ClickHouse · Python · SQL

- Built the Developer Relations function from scratch - sole owner of content, community, docs, events, and video; focused on making developers genuinely successful first, business results followed
- Rewrote docs end-to-end: Quickstart completions went from zero to 25/week, docs traffic grew 302%, and docs became a measurable activation channel
- Grew organic traffic 4x in under 3 months (~1,350 → 5,600+ visitors/week); two target keywords reached #1
- Monthly MQLs hit 239% of target; content became a measurable pipeline channel, with organic readers converting to trials and closed deals with no paid touchpoints
- Published 80+ technical posts across cloud security, IaC, and data engineering; ran a webinar series, YouTube channel, and spoke at conferences
- Embedded across Engineering, Product, and Sales - attended daily standups and merged 480+ PRs directly into production
- Replicated the content playbook at env0.com post-merger: +106% organic traffic in 3 weeks

Senior Developer Advocate

2023 - 2024

Tinybird · Remote

SQL · ClickHouse · BigQuery · Kafka · Snowflake · Redshift · Python · GCP · AWS

- Partnered closely with the Sales team on pre-sales support and customer demos - integrated with prospects' existing tech stacks to build tailored demos that showed exactly how Tinybird fit their architecture
- Built real-time technical integrations for demos and customer proof-of-concepts: fraud detection system on GCP/BigQuery/Kafka (33% reduction in fraudulent transactions); BigQuery IoT optimization for a trucking firm (40% compute cost reduction, 30% faster data retrieval)
- Produced technical content, videos, and webinars covering real-time analytics use cases for a developer audience
- Built community through workshops, online forums, and conference representation

Senior Developer Advocate

2021 - 2023

SingleStore · Remote

- Led content and video production strategy for SingleStore's developer audience - technical tutorials, conference talks, and demos targeting developers migrating from MySQL and PostgreSQL
- Built co-marketing partnerships with cloud providers and tooling partners, coordinating joint content, webinars, and conference activations with their marketing and DevRel teams
- Planned and executed developer conference presence end-to-end: talk submissions, booth strategy, event logistics, and post-event content amplification
- Worked cross-functionally with Engineering, Documentation, and Sales to align content with product launches, maintain technical accuracy, and support pre-sales needs

Developer Advocate

2019 - 2021

MongoDB · Remote

JavaScript · Node.js · Python · React · MongoDB · AWS

- Keynoted at MongoDB World and led global conference event strategy; when COVID hit, pivoted to lead MongoDB's digital growth strategy across Twitch, YouTube, and social - driving developer awareness and product adoption through an entirely new channel mix
- Built memorable technical demos to showcase MongoDB features in creative, engaging ways: IoT kitty litter box, IoT digital graffiti board, and dozens of other projects that drove community growth and product awareness
- Owned MongoDB's live stream and video production, building a 25K+ TikTok following; ranked #1 on "Must-Follow Developers on TikTok"
- Played a key role in defining and standardizing MongoDB developer best practices - authored canonical guides and videos on schema design, aggregation, and Atlas that became the reference point for the ecosystem; published across MongoDB Developer Hub, The New Stack, and Medium

Front End Technical Lead

2017 - 2019

Best Buy · Minneapolis, MN

JavaScript · Node.js · React · Redux · Express · AWS

- Led a cross-functional team of 10 engineers, QA, and product on one of the top 3 largest eCommerce sites in North America - a platform handling millions of users and thousands of requests per second
- Owned Account Home for bestbuy.com end-to-end: drove full redesign and implementation partnering closely with UX, product, and backend teams
- Engineered AI-driven chatbot using NLP and ML that reduced customer support call volume by 25%

Full-Stack JavaScript Instructor

2015 - 2017

DevLeague · Honolulu, HI

ES6 · JavaScript · Node.js · React · Angular · PostgreSQL · AWS

- Taught full-stack JavaScript at one of the top 10 coding bootcamps worldwide
- Developed curriculum, led workshops, and mentored students into engineering roles at local and national companies

SKILLS

LANGUAGES

JavaScript, TypeScript, Python, Go, Rust, SQL

AI & AUTOMATION

LLM APIs, AI Workflow Automation, Prompt Engineering, AI-assisted Content Pipelines, Sales Enablement Automation

DATABASES

MongoDB, PostgreSQL, MySQL, ClickHouse, Redis, Elasticsearch, SingleStore

FRONTEND

React, Redux, Astro, Tailwind CSS, D3.js

CLOUD & DATA

AWS, GCP, Azure, BigQuery, Snowflake, Kafka, Airflow

DEVREL & MARKETING

Technical Writing, Conference Speaking, Content Strategy, SEO, Conversion Optimization, Sales Enablement, Marketing Analytics, Community, Webinars

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Arts in Computer Science

2008 - 2012

Gustavus Adolphus College

GPA: 3.5 · Minors: Art History, Math